



TITLE OF POLICY

Offices of Medical Student Education: Artificial Intelligence Policy

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This policy defines and covers integration of Artificial Intelligence (AI) into the MD curriculum and delineates acceptable uses of AI technologies in the SOM MD curriculum.

This policy reviews responsible integration of AI into the MD curriculum and applies to student use of AI in the medical education program across academic and clinical learning environments. It applies to coursework, independent study, formative learning activities, and assessments unless a course, clerkship, or assignment states otherwise. Course and clerkship directors may establish alternative expectations for specific learning activities or assessments. UNC guidance recommends that instructors state their AI expectations clearly and align them with course learning goals.

RESPONSIBLE PARTY AND REVIEW CYCLE

The Education Committee will review and approve the policy in even-numbered years.

LCME REFERENCE(S)

LCME 7.2: Patient Care

LCME 7.7: Medical Ethics

HISTORY OF APPROVALS AND UPDATES

Approved by Education Committee July 2026

DEFINITION(S)

- **Machine learning:** systems that learn patterns from data, like spam filters.
- **Natural language processing (NLP):** tools that understand or generate text, like chatbots.
- **Computer vision:** systems that interpret images or video, like facial recognition.
- **Speech recognition:** converts spoken language into text, like voice assistants.
- **Generative AI:** creates new content, like text, images, or code.
- **HIPAA-compliant:** The Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act protects the privacy and security of patients' health information and limits how that information can be used or shared.
- **FERPA-protected records:** The Family Educational Rights and Privacy Act protects education records that contain information directly related to a student such as grades, class schedules, and advising notes.
- **Protected health information (PHI):** any individually identifiable health information such as a patient's name linked to a diagnosis, test results, medical record number, date of birth or address when connected to health information.
- **Personally identifiable information (PII):** information that can be used to identify, contact, or trace a person such as name, date and place of birth, address, email address, or biometric data.

POLICY

Artificial intelligence (AI) technologies (including but not limited to machine learning (ML), natural language processing (NLP), computer vision, speech recognition, generative AI) may support learning when used responsibly, transparently, and in ways that strengthen, not replace, student thinking, clinical reasoning, and professional development. Consistent with UNC guidance, students remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, and integrity of all the work they submit. AI should assist your learning, not think for you.

Unless explicitly prohibited by the course director, students may use [approved AI tools](#) to support learning in limited ways, such as:

- reviewing and reinforcing concepts, differential diagnoses, and treatment guidelines;
- exploring clinical reasoning and decision-making frameworks;
- preparing for examinations and shelf exams;
- generating study aids or practice questions for personal use; and
- brainstorming ideas.

Students must independently verify AI-generated information before relying on it.

Boundaries and Restrictions on AI Use

Limits on AI use are necessary to ensure students develop and demonstrate their own clinical reasoning, knowledge, and professional judgment. Because AI outputs may be inaccurate, biased, or incomplete, AI should support learning, not replace independent thinking, clinical decision-making, or accountability.

- **Assessments and assignments (MK 1–5; PC 5–9; PBL 3–5; IC 2–4; PR 2):** AI use is prohibited to complete assessments, assignments, and reflections intended to evaluate the student's individual knowledge, judgment, or clinical reasoning unless explicitly authorized.

AI use for routine spelling, grammar, punctuation, and formatting are permitted as long as it does not alter the content of the student's original work and does not require disclosure unless otherwise specified.

Use of citation-management assistance with AI should be disclosed.

- **Clinical documentation and patient-related work (PC 1–9; IC 2–4; PR 1–2; SBP 4):** AI use for clinical documentation must follow clinical-site policies and privacy requirements. Unless supported by approved institutional systems or explicitly permitted by the course, clerkship, clinical site, or supervisor, students may not use AI to generate, substantially modify, or fabricate H&Ps, patient notes, assessment and plans, or case presentations. These activities demonstrate data gathering, synthesis, communication, and clinical reasoning, not merely written documentation.
- **Patient confidentiality and sensitive information (PR 1–2; PC 8; SBP 4):** Students may not enter protected health information (PHI) into any AI system unless they have been explicitly informed by the institution that the system is HIPAA-compliant and approved for the use of PHI. PHI, FERPA-protected records, personally identifiable information (PII), and other

sensitive institutional data may not be entered into public, non-approved, or otherwise unauthorized AI systems.

- **Proprietary faculty-generated teaching materials:** Students may not upload proprietary faculty-generated teaching materials to any external AI platform. Microsoft CoPilot and LLMs accessed through [UNC PromptLab](#) are permitted for this purpose.
- **AI Meeting Summaries**

Students may not use AI-generated meeting summaries without the knowledge and consent of all meeting participants. This applies to in-person meetings and virtual meetings, including Zoom. Students should follow [best practices](#) for notifying meeting participants of the use of meeting summaries when they are in use.

These restrictions are consistent with [UNC guidance](#) to align AI use with learning goals and with institutional expectations regarding responsible use of AI and sensitive data.

Clinical Use

Students must not rely on AI-generated output as a substitute for clinical judgment. Institutional policies at clinical sites may impose additional restrictions or limitations on AI use, which must be followed.

Disclosure and responsibility

AI should not be used in any assignment unless explicitly permitted. When AI use is allowed, students must disclose that use in the manner required by the course director and remain fully responsible for:

- the accuracy of content
- appropriate citation or acknowledgment
- compliance with course expectations
- academic integrity and professionalism

Violations

Improper AI use may constitute a violation of course policy, professionalism standards, and/or academic integrity expectations and may result in assignment failure, loss of professionalism points, course failure, referral to the Student Progress Committee, and/or referral through university student conduct processes.

Approved tools and updates

Students should use only UNC-approved AI tools for any permitted academic or clinical purpose. Because AI technologies and institutional guidance are evolving rapidly, this policy is subject to periodic review and revision.